



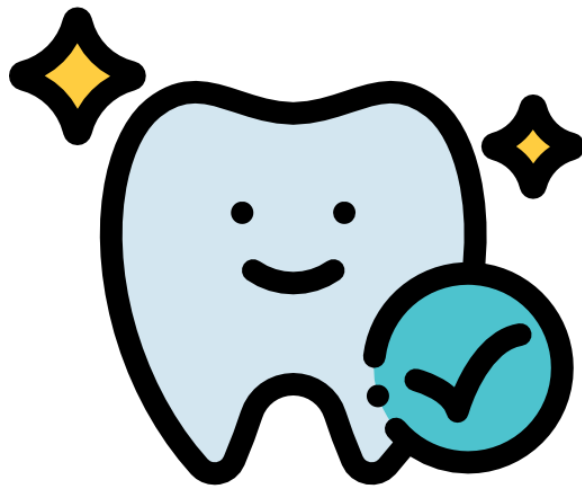
COMMUNITY Lab 2

Patient's setting
**Third stage- College of
Dentistry**

**Dr. Eman witwit
M.Sc. Preventive
Dentistry**

Learning objective

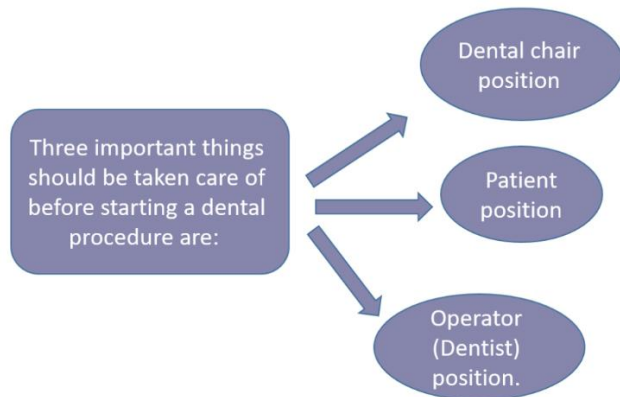
- Identify the ideal working positions for dentists to enhance visibility and access to the oral cavity.
- Understand the importance of patient comfort and safety in relation to chair positioning.
- Describe proper patient positioning techniques for various procedures .



Patient's setting

Patient and Operator positions in Dentistry

The practice of dentistry is demanding and stressful. Physical problems may arise if appropriate working position is neglected



❖ **The patient in a comfortable position is more relaxed and more capable of cooperating with the dentist.**

➤ Dental chair position

- 1- Modern dental chairs are designed to **provide** total **body support** and **comfort** to the patient.
- 2- Chair design and adjustment permit maximal operator **access to** the **work area**.
- 3- The chair should be **low**, the **back rest upright** and the arm rest adjusted to allow the patient to get into the chair.
- 4- After the patient is seated, the arm rest is returned to its normal position. The headrest cushion is positioned to support the head and elevate the **chin slightly away from chest** so that neck muscle strain is minimal and **swallowing** is facilitated. The chair is then adjusted to place the patient in a reclining position.
- 5- The **operating light** is situated **above the patient's** head and its direction to the arch being examined
- 6- The **operating stool** must have a **broad base** for stability and must be **padded** and **offer good back support**



➤ Patient position

The common patient positions in dentistry are:

- 1) Upright position.
- 2) Reclined position: The chair is reclined at 45°.
- 3) Supine position: The patient's head, knees and feet should be approximately at the same level.
- 4) Emergency position: Patient's head should be positioned lower than the feet.



Fig.2 Upright position.



Fig.3 Reclined position.



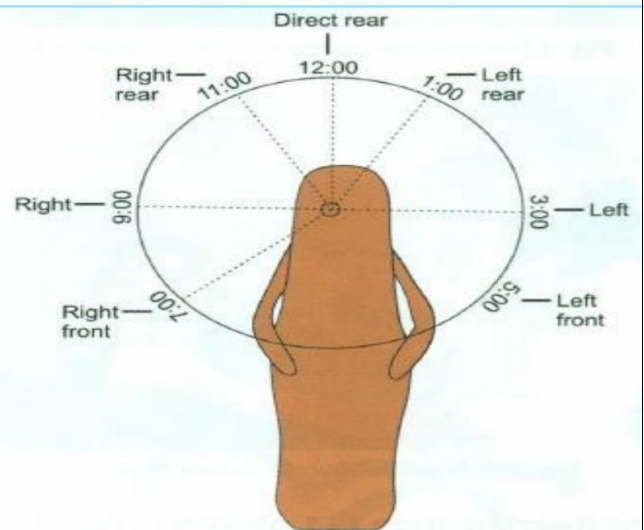
Fig.4 Supine position.



Fig.5 Emergency position.

➤ Operating position

- Proper operating positions and good posture reduce fatigue and physical strain and possibility of developing musculoskeletal disorders.
- Most dental procedures can be accomplished while seated. Unnecessary curvature of the spine or slumping of should be avoided.
- For a right-handed operator there are essentially 4 positions. They are RIGHT FRONT, RIGHT, RIGHT REAR and DIRECT REAR positions. These are sometimes referred as 7-,9-, 11- and 12- o'clock positions, respectively.
- For a left-handed operator LEFT FRONT, LEFT, LEFT REAR and DIRECT REAR positions, these are referred as 5-,3-, 1-and 12-o'clock positions, respectively.



نشوف انتيرير ابر و لور



➤ Right Front Position (7 o'clock)

1. It helps in examination of the patient
2. Working areas include:
 - a. Mandibular anterior
 - b. Mandibular posterior teeth (Right side)
 - c. Maxillary anterior teeth

بوستيرير تيٲ ابر ولور

➤ Right Position (9 o'clock)

Working areas include:

- a. Facial surfaces of maxillary right posterior teeth
- b. Facial surfaces of mandibular right posterior teeth
- c. Occlusal surfaces of mandibular right posterior teeth.

كل اللور تيٲ

➤ Right Rear Position (11 o'clock)

اكثر وضع استعماله ومفضل

1. In this position, dentist sits behind and slightly to the right of the patient and the left arm is positioned around patient's head
2. This is preferred position for most of dental procedures
3. Most areas of mouth are accessible from this position either using direct or indirect vision
4. Working areas include:
 - a. Palatal and incisal (occlusal) surfaces of maxillary teeth
 - b. Mandibular teeth (direct vision).

انتيرير لور لنغول

➤ Direct Rear Position (12 o'clock)

1. Dentist sits directly behind the patient and looks down over the patient's head during procedure.
2. Working areas are lingual surfaces of mandibular teeth.